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'I NEVER EXPECTED TO BE AROUND THIS LONG'

Aging with AIDS

OPTIMISTIC SPIRIT: Despite health problems that come with growing older, those with disease celebrate life

LIFO CHING/STAFF

Bob Reed trims rose bushes in the garden at his home in Saratoga. Reed was diagnosed with AIDS in 1986; since then, he has battled stroke and heart disease. Still, he says, "I'm just one of the luckiest guys I know."

By Sandy Kleffman
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Not long after Bob Reed learned in 1986 that he had AIDS, he watched 20 of his friends die from the disease as it ravaged his body and he battled to survive.

Today, as he sits in his Saratoga home feeling better than he has in years, he ponders a question no one can answer.

"Why did I make it and other people didn't?" he asks. "There's a part of me that has a little bit of survivor guilt."

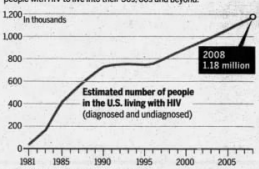
As the epidemic enters its fourth decade, the 57-year-old Saratoga resident is among a growing number of people who are living with HIV or AIDS into their 50s, 60s and beyond, surviving with a new generation of medications that have greatly increased life expectancy.

Before the mid-1990s, three-quarters of people infected with HIV, the virus that causes AIDS, died within 10 years. Now, for those who get early diagno-

See **LIVING**, *Page 6*

Living longer with HIV infection

Starting in 1995, antiretroviral treatments began to allow many people with HIV to live into their 50s, 60s and beyond.



Source: CDC; HIV prevalence estimated from national HIV data for people 13 and older

BAY AREA NEWS GROUP

COUNTERING NORTH KOREA

U.S. to beef up missile defense

Pentagon to deploy interceptors on West Coast after threats and to warn China to rein in Kim

By Thom Shanker, David E. Sanger and Martin Fackler
New York Times

WASHINGTON — The Pentagon will spend $1 billion to deploy additional ballistic missile interceptors along the Pacific Coast to counter the growing reach of North Korea's weapons, a decision accelerated by Pyongyang's recent belligerence and indications that Kim Jong Un, the North Korean leader, is resisting China's efforts to restrain him.

The new deployments, announced by Defense Secretary Chuck Hagel on Friday, will increase the number of ground-based interceptors on the West Coast to 44 from 30 by 2017. The missiles have a mixed record in testing, hit-

See **MISSILES**, *Page 6*

YURI GRIPAS/REUTERS

U.S. Secretary of Defense Chuck Hagel said Friday that 14 new ground-based missile interceptors will be installed in Alaska.

GUILTY OF FRAUD

Seeno exec takes plea deal, agrees to testify against firm

Unexpected development could bolster the FBI's criminal case

By Matthias Gafni
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OAKLAND — A top Seeno company sales executive pleaded guilty Friday to one count of wire fraud in exchange for her testimony against her employer, a dramatic twist in the Seeno saga that could strengthen the criminal case against the powerful real estate empire.

The attorney for Carey Hendrickson, 37, of Martinez, also spoke to Bay Area News Group for the first time, saying his client will testify if called before a grand jury or trial and that she was a small player in the case that began with

See **SEENO**, *Page 8*

'A VERY INTELLIGENT ADVERSARY'

Critical utilities in hackers' cross hairs

Energy grids serving millions are at risk, security officials fear

By Steve Johnson
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Hackers are increasingly targeting electric, natural gas and other vital utilities, threatening a disaster of epic proportions that experts say firms are doing too little to guard against.

"We will see catastrophic outages," James Sample, PG&E's chief information security officer, warned state regulators at a recent forum, though not specifically referring to his company. "We are dealing with a very intelligent adversary."

The threat is regarded by U.S. officials and others as among the most worrisome the nation faces. A cyberattack could so severely damage a utility that millions of people might be left without power for months, experts say, shutting down water and transportation systems, threatening the sick and elderly and causing billions of dollars in damage.

Online extra: Read how a cascade of cybersecurity threats could cause havoc at an electric utility at www.mercurynews.com/extra.

"How many days could hospitals operate with on-site electricity generation?" Rep. Cliff Stearns, R-Fla., asked during a congressional hearing he led last year into the cyberthreat faced by power grids. "How would metro rail systems operate, if at all? How would we recharge our smartphones or access the Internet?"

Late last year, a branch of the U.S. Department of Homeland Security reported seeing hackers infiltrating "oil

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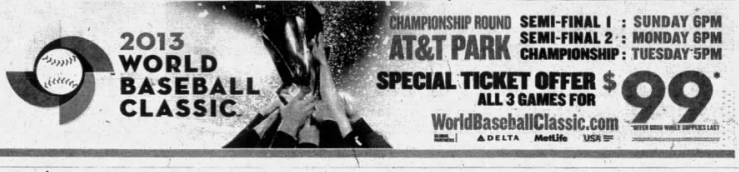
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